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United States Patent	12412996
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
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Dual wideband orthogonally polarized antenna

Abstract

Systems, devices, and methods related to dual wideband antennas with arbitrary frequency ranges are provided. An example antenna structure includes a high-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a first signal in a first frequency band; a low-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a second signal in a second frequency band lower than the first frequency band, wherein the low-band patch antenna is stacked vertically below the high-band patch antenna and spaced apart from the high-band patch antenna by a dielectric substrate; a high-band excitation via electrically coupled to the high-band patch antenna; and a low-band excitation via electrically coupled to the low-band patch antenna, wherein the high-band excitation via is separate from the low-band excitation via.

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Appl. No.: 17/670268

Filed: February 11, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230261392 A1	Aug. 17, 2023

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H01Q21/06 (20060101); H01Q9/04 (20060101); H01Q21/30 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H01Q21/065** (20130101); **H01Q9/0414** (20130101); **H01Q21/30** (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H01Q (21/065); H01Q (9/0414)

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

(1) The present disclosure generally relates to electronics, and more particularly to antennas used in radio frequency (RF) systems.

BACKGROUND

(2) RF systems are systems that transmit and receive signals in the form of electromagnetic waves with a frequency range of approximately 3 kilohertz (kHz) to 300 gigahertz (GHz). RF systems are commonly used for wireless communications, with cellular/wireless mobile technology being a prominent example.

(3) In the context of RF systems, an antenna is a device that serves as the interface between radio waves propagating wirelessly through space and electric currents moving in metal conductors used with a transmitter or receiver. During transmission, a radio transmitter supplies an electric current to the antenna's terminals, and the antenna radiates the energy from the current as radio waves. During reception, an antenna intercepts some of the power of a radio wave to produce an electric current at its terminals, where the electric current is subsequently applied to a receiver to be amplified. Antennas are essential components of all radio equipment, and are used in radio broadcasting, broadcast television, two-way radio, communications receivers, radar, cell phones, satellite communications and other devices.

(4) An antenna with a single antenna element may broadcast a radiation pattern that radiates equally in all directions in a spherical wavefront. Phased array antennas may generally refer to a collection of antenna elements that are used to focus electromagnetic energy in a particular spatial direction, thereby creating a main beam. Phased array antennas may offer numerous advantages over single antenna systems, such as high gain, ability to perform directional steering, and simultaneous communication. Therefore, phased array antennas may be used more frequently in a myriad of different applications, such as in military applications, mobile technology, on airplane radar technology, automotive radars, cellular telephone and data, and Wi-Fi technology.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) To provide a more complete understanding of the present disclosure and features and

advantages thereof, reference is made to the following description, taken in conjunction with the accompanying figures, wherein like reference numerals represent like parts, in which:

- (2) FIG. 1A illustrates an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure, according to some embodiments of the disclosure;
- (3) FIG. 1B is a bottom view of an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure, according to some embodiments of the disclosure;
- (4) FIG. 1C is a sideview of an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure, according to some embodiments of the disclosure;
- (5) FIG. 1D is a top view of an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure, according to some embodiments of the disclosure;
- (6) FIG. 1E is a top view of an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure, according to some embodiments of the disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 2 is a bottom view of an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure, according to some embodiments of the disclosure;
- (8) FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary dual wideband antenna apparatus, according to some embodiments of the disclosure;
- (9) FIG. 4 is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary dual wideband antenna apparatus, according to some embodiments of the disclosure;
- (10) FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary dual wideband antenna apparatus, according to some embodiments of the disclosure; and
- (11) FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating an antenna apparatus, according to some embodiments of the disclosure.

DESCRIPTION OF EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS OF THE DISCLOSURE

(12) Overview

(13) The systems, methods and devices of this disclosure each have several innovative embodiments, no single one of which is solely responsible for all of the desirable attributes disclosed herein. Details of one or more implementations of the subject matter described in this specification are set forth in the description below and the accompanying drawings.

(14) As described above, antennas can be used in an RF system to transmit and/or receive radio waves wirelessly through space. As the demand for wireless communication continues to grow, there is an interest in developing wireless communications over millimeter wave bands due to the large bandwidths available at these high frequencies. For instance, fifth generation (5G) systems and networks may utilize 28 GHz and 39 GHz millimeter spectrum bands to provide services with higher data rates and/or lower latencies than services provided in lower frequency bands. As such, there is a need to design dual band antennas, for example, to operate over 28 GHz and 39 GHz bands. An antenna is typically designed to radiate at a certain resonant frequency. Dual band operations can easily be achieved at multiples of the antenna resonant frequency. However, when two bands are relatively close to each other in frequency, for example, at about 28 GHz and about 39 GHz as mentioned, it may be challenging to achieve dual band operations, and particularly having wide bandwidths for both frequency bands. For instance, it may be desirable for a 28/39 GHz dual band antenna to provide a bandwidth of about 5.5 GHz to about 6.5 GHz for each of the 28 GHz band and the 39 GHz bands. In general, a dual wideband antenna may refer to an antenna that can provide a fractional bandwidth of about 8% or more for each of the dual bands.

(15) In some examples, a dual band antenna may be formed from a single patch antenna. However, dual bands provided by a signal patch antenna may typically have a wide bandwidth for only one of the bands. For example, a single patch antenna may provide a bandwidth of about 1.6 GHz for a 28 GHz band and a bandwidth of about 3.5 GHz for a 39 GHz band). While a more complex structure or design (e.g., an electromagnetic band gap (EBG) structure) can be incorporated into a single patch antenna to enhance the bandwidths for the dual bands, it may still be difficult to achieve a wide bandwidth for each of the dual bands. Furthermore, the complex EBG structure can increase

the size and/or cost of the antenna, and thus may be undesirable. In other examples, a dual band antenna may be formed from two stacked patch antennas, for example, including one patch antenna operative at a high frequency band and another patch antenna operative at a low frequency band. However, these stacked patch antennas may typically operate based on capacitively couplings between the two patch antennas. As such, the design of the stacked patch antennas is tightly coupled to the specific frequency ranges of the dual bands, and thus may not be easily scaled to any arbitrary frequency ranges. Further, because of the capacitive coupling between the two patch antennas, it may also be difficult to achieve a wide bandwidth for each of the dual bands.

(16) The present disclosure describes mechanisms for providing dual wideband orthogonally polarized antennas operative at arbitrary frequency bands. The disclosed antenna structures or elements are based on two independent stacked patch antennas, each radiates independently at a separate frequency band at any arbitrary frequency ranges with an appropriate bandwidth. In one aspect of the present disclosure, a dual wideband antenna structure may include a high-band patch antenna and a low-band patch antenna stacked below the high-band patch antenna and spaced apart from the high-band patch antenna by a dielectric material or substrate. The high-band patch antenna may be a first patch antenna having a first resonant frequency within a first frequency band, and the low-band patch antenna may be a second, separate patch antenna having a second resonant frequency within a second frequency band lower in frequency than the first frequency band. The low-band patch antenna may have a larger size than the high-band patch antenna to operate in the lower frequency band. The high-band patch antenna and the low-band patch antenna may radiate independent of each other. To that end, the antenna structure may further include a high-band excitation via (e.g., a first excitation conductor) electrically coupled to the high-band patch antenna and a separate low-band excitation via (e.g., a second excitation conductor) electrically coupled to the low-band patch antenna. In some aspects, the antenna structure may include a multi-layered structure (e.g., a multi-layered printed circuit board (PCB) structure including multiple conductive layers separated by a dielectric material), where the high-band patch antenna may be disposed on a first layer of the structure, the low-band patch antenna may be disposed on a second layer of the structure vertically below the first layer, and the high-band excitation via and the low-band excitation via may extend vertically from a third layer of the structure vertically below the second layer. The third layer may include one or more excitation striplines where signals are fed to and/or from the high-band patch antenna and the low-band patch antenna. The third layer can be between an upper ground layer and a lower ground layer of the structure, where the upper ground layer and the lower ground layer are vertically below the second layer.

(17) In one aspect, the antenna structure may include a single excitation or feeding port for both the high-band patch antenna and the low-band patch antenna. In this regard, the antenna structure may include a single excitation stripline or stripline feed (e.g., a third excitation conductor) disposed on the third layer. For the high-band patch antenna and the low-band patch antenna to operate independent of each other, the antenna structure may further include a frequency selective coupling (FSC) element. The FSC element may be a coupler or filter that couples signals at a specific frequency range while reflecting signals at any other frequency ranges. For instance, the FSC element may couple (or pass) high-frequency signals (in the first frequency band) but may reflect low-frequency signals (in the second frequency band). Accordingly, the low-band patch antenna may be electrically coupled to the excitation stripline directly while the high-band patch antenna may be electrically coupled to the excitation stripline indirectly through the FSC element.

(18) In another aspect, the antenna structure may include separate feeding ports (dual excitation ports) for the high-band patch antenna and low-band patch antenna. In this regard, the antenna structure may include a first excitation stripline (e.g., a third excitation conductor) and a second, separate excitation stripline (e.g., a fourth excitation conductor) disposed on the third layer of the structure. The first excitation stripline may be electrically coupled to the high-band excitation via

(which is connected and in contact with the high-band patch antenna), and the second excitation stripline may be electrically coupled to the low-band excitation via (which is connected and in contact with the low-band patch antenna).

(19) In some aspects, the high-band patch antenna may be associated with a first polarization, and the low-band patch antenna may be associated with a second polarization different from the first polarization. For instance, the high-band patch antenna may radiate radio waves with one of a horizontal polarization or a vertical polarization, and the low-band patch antenna may radiate radio waves with the other one of the horizontal polarization or the vertical polarization. In this way, the high-band patch antenna and the low-band patch antenna can simultaneously communicate in respective first and second frequency bands without impacting each other's performance.

(20) In some aspects, at least one of the high-band patch antenna or the low-band patch antenna may include a resonant slot or opening (e.g., a U-shaped opening) to enhance (or widen) a corresponding operational bandwidth.

(21) In a further aspect of the present disclosure, a dual band antenna array apparatus may include a plurality of dual band antenna elements, each including two independent stacked patch antennas with a single stripline excitation or dual stripline excitations as discussed herein. The antenna array apparatus may further include beamformer circuitry coupled to the plurality of dual band antenna elements. The beamformer circuitry may include a plurality of beamformer channels. For the antenna configuration with dual stripline excitations, a first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels may be associated with the first frequency band (e.g., a high frequency band), and a second, different, subset of the plurality of beamformer channels may be associated with the second frequency band (e.g., a low frequency band). In one aspect, the beamformer circuitry may include two separate beamformer integrated circuit (BFICs), a first BFIC and a second, separate BFIC. The first BFIC may include the first subset of the beamformer channels for beamforming signals in the first, higher frequency band. The second BFIC may include the second subset of the beamformer channels for beamforming signals in the second, lower frequency band. In another aspect, the beamformer circuitry may be a single BFIC, where the first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the high frequency band can be arranged in an interleaving manner. For instance, the first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels may be spaced apart (physically) from each other by the second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels in the BFIC. For the antenna configuration with a single stripline excitation, the beamformer circuitry may be a single BFIC and the beamformer channels may be dual band beamformer channels.

(22) The systems, schemes, and mechanisms described herein advantageously provide techniques (e.g., a systematic approach) for designing dual band antennas that can radiate or operate in arbitrary frequency ranges. Accordingly, dual band antennas using the disclosed structure can be easily configured to support dual band operations at any frequency ranges with appropriate bandwidths. Further, utilizing dual band antennas can allow a dual band system to utilize a single antenna or antenna array for both frequency bands rather than two separate antennas or antenna arrays, and thus can save system cost, system footprint, and/or simplify design.

Example Dual Wideband Antennas with a Single Stripline Excitation

(23) FIGS. **1A-1E** are discussed in relation to each other to illustrate an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure **100**. The antenna structure **100** may be suitable for use in an RF system for wireless transmission and/or reception. The antenna structure **100** may be suitable for use with beamformers to provide beam steering (e.g., as shown in FIGS. **3-6**).

(24) FIG. **1A** illustrates a sectional view of the exemplary dual wideband antenna structure **100**, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. The sectional view may be taken along the line **105** of FIG. **1B** and shows a vertical arrangement of the antenna structure **100**. At a high level, the antenna structure may include two independent patch antennas (e.g., a high-band patch antenna **120** and a separate low-band patch antenna **130**) arranged on top of each other in a multi-layered structure (e.g., a multi-layered printed circuit board (PCB) stack-up) with a single excitation. The

single excitation may refer to the feeding port that interfaces external signals into and/or out of the antenna structure **100**, for example, from a beamformer in the case of transmission or to a beamformer in the case of reception, respectively. The multi-layered structure may include a plurality of conductive layers (e.g., shown **102**, **104**, **106**, **108**, and **110**) spaced apart by insulating layers **112**. The conductive layers may be made of copper or any suitable conductive material. The insulating layers **112** may be made of dielectric material or any suitable insulating material. The conductive layers may be configured to operate as signal layers or ground layers. In the illustrated example of FIG. **1A**, the antenna structure **100** may have three signal layers (e.g., a first layer **102**, a second layer **104**, and a third layer **108**) and two ground layers (e.g., an upper ground layer **140** and a lower ground layer **142**).

(25) As shown in FIG. **1A**, the high-band patch antenna **120** is disposed on the first layer **102** (e.g., a top layer or an outer layer) of the antenna structure **100** and, the low-band patch antenna **130** is disposed on the second layer **104** of the antenna structure **100**. The second layer **104** is vertically below the first layer **102**. The high-band patch antenna **120** may be a radiating planar element with a first resonant frequency within a first frequency band. The low-band patch antenna **130** may be a radiating planar element with a second resonant frequency within a second frequency band lower in frequency than the first frequency band. Phrased differently, the high-band patch antenna **120** may be excitable by high-frequency signals with a frequency range within the first frequency band, and the low-band patch antenna **130** may be excitable by low-frequency signals with a frequency range within the second frequency band. In some instances, the first resonant frequency of the high-band patch antenna **120** are non-integer multiples of the second resonant frequency of the low-band patch antenna **130** (e.g., with a ratio greater than 1 and less than 2). In some specific examples, the first frequency band may be at about 39 GHz, the second frequency band may be at about 28 GHz band, and the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** may each have a bandwidth of about 5.5 GHz to about 6.5 GHz. To operate in the lower second frequency band, the low-band patch antenna **130** may have a larger size (e.g., a longer length or a large radiating surface area) than the high-band patch antenna **120**.

(26) In some aspects, the low-band patch antenna **130** may be arranged such that the low-band patch antenna **130** is vertically below the high-band patch antenna **120** and at least partially overlaps with the high-band patch antenna **120**. A patch antenna is formed from a planar sheet (or “patch”) of metal arranged above a ground plane. Because the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** operate independent from each other as will be discussed more fully below, the low-band patch antenna **130** can operate as a ground layer to the high-band patch antenna **120**. Further, in some instances, it may be advantageous to arrange the smaller-sized high-band patch antenna **120** on the top layer or outer layer of the antenna structure **100** and the larger-sized low-band patch antenna **130** below the high-band patch antenna **120** so that the high-band radiating mode and the low-band radiating mode can co-exist in the antenna structure **100**.

(27) To interface external signals into and/or out of the high-band patch antenna **120** and/or the low-band patch antenna **130**, the antenna structure **100** may further include an excitation stripline and a FSC element **150** disposed on the third layer **108** of the antenna structure **100**, where the third layer **108** may be between the upper ground layer **140** (e.g., the layer **106**) and the lower ground layer **142** (e.g., the layer **110**). The excitation stripline and the FSC element **150** are shown separately as an excitation stripline **152** and a FSC element **154** in FIG. **1B**. The excitation or feeding mechanisms are discussed more fully below.

(28) As further shown in FIG. **1A**, the antenna structure **100** includes a high-band excitation via **122** (e.g., a vertical electrical conductor) extending vertically from the third layer **108**, through the second layer **104**, to the first layer **102**. More specifically, the high-band excitation via **122** may have one end electrically coupled (e.g., a direct connection) to the high-band patch antenna **120** and another end electrically coupled to the excitation stripline and FSC element **150**. The high-band excitation via **122** may extend through the upper ground layer **140** and the low-band patch antenna

130 without contacting the upper ground layer **140** and the low-band patch antenna **130**. For instance, the upper ground layer **140** and the second layer **104** may include respective openings or through holes at which the high-band excitation via **122** passes through the upper ground layer **140** and the second layer **104**. In a similar way, the antenna structure **100** includes a low-band excitation via **132** (e.g., a vertical electrical conductor) extending vertically from the third layer **108** to the second **104**. More specifically, the low-band excitation via **132** may have one end electrically coupled (e.g., a direct connection) to the low-band patch antenna **130** and another end electrically coupled to the excitation stripline and FSC element **150**. The low-band excitation via **132** may extend through the upper ground layer **140** without contacting the upper ground layer **140**. For instance, the upper ground layer **140** may include an opening or a through hole at which the low-band excitation via **132** passes through the upper ground layer **140**.

(29) As can be seen in FIG. **1A**, the high-band excitation via **122** and the low-band excitation via **132** are individual vias separate from each other. That is, the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** are independently fed through a respective direct electrical connection. Thus, the high-band excitation via **122** and the low-band excitation via **132** are independent feeding points. In operation, the high-band excitation via **122** may propagate a high-frequency signal in the first frequency band (e.g., at about 39 GHz) to the high-band patch antenna **120** for transmission (e.g., in the form of electromagnetic waves in a free space). For reception, the high-band excitation via **122** may propagate a high-frequency signal in the first frequency band received by the high-band patch antenna **120**. In a similar way, the low-band excitation via **132** may propagate a low-frequency signal in the second frequency band (e.g., at about 28 GHz) to the low-band patch antenna **130** for transmission (e.g., in the form of electromagnetic waves in a free space). For reception, the low-band excitation via **132** may propagate a low-frequency signal in the second frequency band received by the low-band patch antenna **130**.

(30) As further shown in FIG. **1A**, the antenna structure **100** may include a shielding via **160** extending between the lower ground layer **142** and the upper ground layer **140**. The shielding via **160** is a vertical connection in the antenna structure **100**. In general, the antenna structure **100** may include any suitable number of shielding vias (e.g., 2, 3, 4, 5 or more) placed in any suitable locations. Shielding vias may generally be placed along a route or via that carries an RF signal to reduce crosstalk and electromagnetic interference to the route. For instance, the shielding via **160** may be placed to reduce interference for a signal propagating along the high-band excitation via **122**.

(31) While FIG. **1A** illustrates the antenna structure **100** having five conductive layers (e.g., **102**, **104**, **106**, **108**, and **110**), in other instances, the antenna structure **100** can include any suitable number of conductive layers (e.g., about 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12 or more).

(32) FIG. **1B** is a bottom view of the exemplary dual wideband antenna structure **100**, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. The bottom view is from the bottom of the third layer **108** of the antenna structure **100**. In order not to clutter the drawings provided in FIG. **1B**, the insulating layers **112** are not shown in FIG. **1B**.

(33) As shown in FIG. **1B**, each of the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** are planar rectangular shaped patch of conductive material. The high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** can be arranged such that the long side of the high-band patch antenna **120** is about perpendicular to the long side of the low-band patch antenna **130**. That is, the high-band patch antenna **120** may be rotated by about 90 degrees compared to the low-band patch antenna **130**. As such, the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** may radiate with orthogonal polarizations. In the illustrated example of FIG. **1A**, the high-band patch antenna **120** may radiate with a vertical polarization, and the low-band patch antenna **130** may radiate with a horizontal polarization. Because of the orthogonal polarizations used by the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130**, the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** may simultaneously communicate in respective

frequency bands without interfering with each other. Furthermore, because of the symmetric structure of the high-band patch antenna **120** with respect to the high-band excitation via **122**, the high-band patch antenna **120** may have a short circuit line (e.g., a virtual short circuit line) as shown by the dotted line **103**. By placing the low-band excitation via **132** along the short circuit line **103** of the high-band patch antenna **120**, any excitation at the low-band excitation via **132** may not affect the performance of the high-band patch antenna **120**. Similarly, because of the symmetric structure of the low-band patch antenna **130** with respect to the low-band excitation via **132**, the low-band patch antenna **130** may have a short circuit line (e.g., a virtual short circuit line) as shown by the dashed line **101**. By placing the high-band excitation via **122** along the short circuit line **101** of the low-band patch antenna **130**, any excitation at the high-band excitation via **132** may not affect the performance of the low-band patch antenna **130**. That is, the placement of the high-band excitation via **122** and the low-band excitation via **132** can further decouple operations of the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130**.

(34) While FIG. **1B** illustrates an arrangement for the high-band patch antenna **120** to radiate with a vertical polarization, and the low-band excitation via **130** to radiate with a horizontal polarization, in other examples, the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** may be arranged (with orientations of the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** swapped) such that the high-band patch antenna **120** may radiate with a horizontal polarization and the low-band patch antenna **130** may radiate with a vertical polarization instead. Further, while FIG. **1B** illustrates the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** as rectangular shaped planar patches, in other examples, the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** can have other shapes (e.g., triangle, circle, lines, and/or any geometrical shape).

(35) As mentioned above, the antenna structure **100** may include an excitation stripline and FSC **150** disposed on the third layer **108** of the structure. FIG. **1B** illustrates the excitation stripline and FSC element **150** separately as an excitation stripline **152** and a FSC element **154** (shown as FSC). The excitation stripline **152** is a transmission line structure configured to feed signals (e.g., from a beamformer) into the antenna structure **100** for transmission (by the high-band patch antenna **120** and/or the low-band patch antenna **130**) and/or feed signals received from the antenna structure **100** (by the high-band patch antenna **120** and/or the low-band patch antenna **130**) to a downstream component (e.g., a beamformer). In some instances, the excitation stripline **152** may be a horizontal conducting line arranged on the third layer **108** with one end near an edge of the antenna structure **100** and extending inwards towards the high-band patch antenna **120** and/or the low-band patch antenna **130**. The FSC element **154** may be a coupler or filter that couples signals at a specific frequency range while reflecting signals at any other frequency ranges. In the illustrated example of FIG. **1B**, the FSC element **154** may couple (or pass) a high-frequency portion of a signal through but may reflect a low-frequency portion of the signal. For instance, the FSC element **154** may be configured to pass a signal in the 39 GHz band through but not a 28 GHz signal. Because the antenna structure **100** utilizes a single excitation to interface signals into and/or out of the antenna structure **100**, the FSC element **154** is used to direct high-frequency signals to the high-band excitation via **122** and isolate low-frequency signals from the high-band excitation via **122**.

(36) As further shown in FIG. **1B** the excitation stripline **152** is connected directly to the low-band excitation via **132**, and indirectly to the high-band excitation via **122** through the FSC element **154**. That is, the FSC element **154** may have one port or terminal coupled to the excitation stripline **152** and another port or terminal coupled to the high-band excitation via **122**.

(37) Referring to the same example with the high-band patch antenna **120** being operative in a 39 GHz band and the low-band patch antenna **130** being operative in a 28 GHz band, when the excitation stripline **152** is excited by a 28 GHz signal (a low-frequency signal), no signal passes through the FSC element **154**. Thus, the entire signal may be propagated to the low-band excitation via **132** which then passes the signal to the low-band patch antenna **130** for transmission. The high-

band patch antenna **120** is not excited in this case. Further, as mentioned above, because the high-band excitation via **122** is located at or aligned to the short circuit line **101** of the low-band patch antenna **130**, the high-band excitation via **122** may not affect the performance of the low-band patch antenna **130**. The low-band patch antenna **130** may radiate the 28 GHz signal with a vertical polarization.

(38) On the other hand, when the excitation stripline **152** is excited by a 39 GHz signal (a high-frequency signal), the entire signal may be propagated to the low-band excitation via **132** and through the FSC element **154** to the high-band excitation via **122**. The low-band patch antenna **130** is not excited in this case. Further, because the low-band excitation via **132** is located at or aligned to the short circuit line **103** of the high-band patch antenna **120**, the low-band excitation via **132** may not affect the performance high-band patch antenna **120**. The high-band patch antenna **120** may radiate the 39 GHz signal with a horizontal polarization. Receptions by the high-band patch antenna **120** and/or the low-band patch antenna **130** may operate in a substantially similar way but in a reverse direction.

(39) FIG. **1C** is a sectional view of the exemplary dual wideband antenna structure **100**, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. The sectional may be taken along the line **105** of FIG. **1B**. As shown in FIG. **1C**, the low-band patch antenna **130** is stacked vertically below the high-band patch antenna **120** and spaced apart from the high-band patch antenna **120** by a dielectric substrate **114** (e.g., corresponding to the insulating layers **112**). The low-band excitation via **132** is directly coupled (and in direct contact with) to the low-band patch antenna **130**. The high-band excitation via **122** is directly coupled to (and in direct contact with) the high-band patch antenna **120**. The high-band excitation via **122** may pass through the low-band patch antenna **130** but without contacting the low-band patch antenna **130**. A more detailed view of the arrangement of the high-band excitation via **122** in the antenna structure **100** is shown in FIGS. **1D** and **1E**.

(40) FIG. **1D** is a top view of the exemplary dual wideband antenna structure **100**, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. **1D** shows the high-band patch antenna **120** being on top of the low-band patch antenna **130**, and the low-band patch antenna **130** being on top of the upper ground layer **140**. In order not to clutter the drawings provided in FIG. **1D**, the insulating layers **112** are not shown in FIG. **1D**. As shown in FIG. **1D**, the high-band excitation via **122** may pass through the low-band patch antenna **130** to connect to the high-band patch antenna **120** without being in contact with the low-band patch antenna **130**. The low-band patch antenna **130** may include an opening or a clearance **134** at which the high-band excitation via **122** passes through so that the high-band excitation via **122** may not be in contact with the low-band patch antenna **130**. Stated differently, the low-band patch antenna **130** may have a discontinuity of conductive material to provide the clearance **134** for the high-band excitation via **122** to pass through.

(41) FIG. **1E** is a top view of an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. In order not to clutter the drawings provided in FIG. **1E**, the insulating layers **112** are not shown in FIG. **1E**. The top view shown in FIG. **1E** is substantially the same as in FIG. **1D** but without the high-band patch antenna **120** (e.g., the high-band patch antenna **120** and the excitation connection pin for the high-band patch antenna **120** disconnected). As can be seen in FIG. **1E**, the low-band patch antenna **130** includes the clearance **134** at which the high-band excitation via **122** passes through. As further shown in FIG. **1E**, the low-band patch antenna **130** may have a U-shaped resonant slot or U-slot **136** (e.g., an opening at about a center of the low-band patch antenna **130**). The inclusion of the U-slot **136** can enhance (e.g., widen) the operational bandwidth of the low-band patch antenna **130**. In general, the high-band patch antenna **120** and/or the low-band patch antenna **130** can incorporate a resonant slot to increase a corresponding operational or radiation bandwidth. In some aspects, the high-band patch antenna **120** may have a fractional bandwidth of about 14%, and the low-band patch antenna **130** may have a fractional bandwidth of about 23%.

(42) While the antenna structure **100** is discussed with the example of the high-band patch antenna

120 operative at a 39 GHz band and the low-band patch antenna **130** operative at a 28 GHz band, the antenna structure **100** can be configured to operate in any frequency ranges. For example, by feeding the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** separately through direct connections by the high-band excitation via **122** and the low-band excitation via **132**, respectively, rather than through parasitic or capacitive coupling between the patches, the antenna structure **100** can be used to provide dual band operations with arbitrary frequency ranges. Further, by incorporating resonant slots, the antenna structure **100** can provide dual wideband operations. Further still, while the antenna structure **100** is illustrated with a FSC element **154** with a high-pass filter, aspects are not limited thereto. For instance, the antenna structure **100** can utilize a FSC element with a low-pass filtering property and the single stripline can be coupled to the high-band excitation via **122** instead of the low-band excitation via **132** as shown in FIG. 1B.

Example Dual Wideband Antennas with Dual Stripline Excitations

(43) FIG. 2 is a bottom view of an exemplary dual wideband antenna structure **200**, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. The antenna structure **200** may be suitable for use in an RF system for wireless transmission and/or reception. The antenna structure **200** may be suitable for use with beamformers to provide beam steering (e.g., as shown in FIGS. 3-6). The antenna structure **200** may be substantially similar to the antenna structure **100** of FIGS. 1A-1E. For instance, the antenna structure **200** may include two independent stacked patch antennas (e.g., a high-band patch antenna **120** and a low-band patch antenna **130**) arranged on a multi-layered structure (e.g., a multi-layer PCB stack-up) where the high-band patch antenna **120** may be disposed on a first layer (e.g., the layer **102**) and the low-band patch antenna **130** may be disposed on a second layer (e.g., the layer **104**) as discussed above with reference to FIGS. 1A-1E. However, the antenna structure **200** may utilize dual stripline excitations instead of a signal stripline excitation. As shown, the antenna structure **200** of FIG. 2 shares many elements with the antenna structure **100** of FIG. 1B; for brevity, a discussion of these elements is not repeated, and these elements may take the form of any of the embodiments disclosed herein.

(44) Similar to FIG. 1B, FIG. 2 shows a bottom view from the bottom of a third layer (e.g., the layer **108**) of the antenna structure **200**. In order not to clutter the drawings provided in FIG. 2, the insulating layers **112** are not shown in FIG. 2. As shown in FIG. 2, the antenna structure **200** may include a high-band excitation stripline **252** and a separate low-band excitation stripline **250**. The high-band excitation stripline **252** may be electrically coupled to the high-band excitation via **122**. That is, the high-band excitation via **122** may have one end electrically coupled (e.g., a direction connection) to the high-band patch antenna **120** and another end electrically coupled (e.g., a direction connection) to the high-band excitation stripline **252**. In a similar way, the low-band excitation stripline **250** may be electrically coupled to the low-band excitation via **132**. That is, the low-band excitation via **132** may have one end electrically coupled (e.g., a direction connection) to the low-band patch antenna **130** and another end electrically coupled (e.g., a direction connection) to the low-band excitation stripline **250**. Each of the excitation striplines **250** and **252** may independently feed signals into and/or out of the antenna structure **200** in a respective frequency band, and each of the low-band patch antenna **130** and the high-band patch antenna **120** may radiate independently in a respective frequency band. In some instances, it may be advantageous to place the high-band excitation stripline **252** and the low-band excitation stripline **250** on opposite sides of the antenna structure **200**, for example, to reduce crosstalk.

(45) Referring to the same example with the high-band patch antenna **120** being operative in a 39 GHz band and the low-band patch antenna **130** being operative in a 28 GHz band, when the low-band excitation stripline **250** is excited by a 28 GHz signal (a low-frequency signal), the signal may propagate to the low-band excitation via **132** and then further to the low-band patch antenna **130**, and the low-band patch antenna **130** may radiate the 28 GHz signal with a horizontal excitation.

(46) Similarly, when the high-band excitation stripline **252** is excited by a 39 GHz signal (a high-frequency signal), the signal may propagate to the high-band excitation via **122** and then further to

the high-band patch antenna **120**, and the high-band patch antenna **120** may radiate the 39 GHz signal with a vertical excitation. Receptions by the high-band patch antenna **120** and/or the low-band patch antenna **130** may operate in a substantially similar way but in a reverse direction. As similarly explained above, because the high-band excitation via **122** is located at or aligned to the short circuit line **101** of the low-band patch antenna **130**, excitations at the high-band excitation via **122** may not affect the performance of the low-band patch antenna **130**. Similarly, because the low-band excitation via **132** is located at or aligned to the short circuit line **103** of the high-band patch antenna **120**, excitations at the low-band excitation via **132** may not affect the performance of the high-band patch antenna **120**. Accordingly, the high-band patch antenna **120** and the low-band patch antenna **130** may radiate simultaneously in respective frequency bands without impacting each other's performance.

Example Dual Wideband Antenna Apparatuses

(47) FIG. **3** is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary dual wideband antenna apparatus **300**, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. The antenna apparatus **300** may be used in an RF system for wireless transmission and/or reception. In some instances, the antenna apparatus **300** may be part of the antenna apparatus **600** of FIG. **6**. As shown in FIG. **3**, the antenna apparatus **300** may include an antenna array **310**, a high-band beamformer array **320**, and a low-band beamformer array **322**.

(48) The antenna array **310** may include a plurality of antenna elements **312** (only one of which is labeled with a reference numeral in FIG. **3** in order to not clutter the drawing). The antenna elements **312** may include any suitable elements configured to wirelessly transmit and/or receive RF signals. In some aspects, the phased array antenna **310** may be a printed phased array antenna. In some aspects, the antenna elements **312** may support dual wideband operations (e.g., at a 39 GHz band and at a 28 GHz band). To that end, the antenna elements **312** may be implemented using two independent stacked patch antennas (e.g., a high-band patch antenna **120** and a low-band patch antenna **130**) arranged on a multi-layered structure (e.g., a multi-layer PCB stack-up) as discussed above with reference to FIGS. **1A-1E** and **2**. In some specific embodiments, the antenna elements **312** may have a structure with dual stripline excitations (e.g., the high-band excitation stripline **252** and the low-band excitation stripline **250**) as discussed above with reference to FIG. **2**.

(49) Each of the high-band beamformer array **320** and the low-band beamformer array **322** may be configured to perform beamforming. Beamforming is a technique by which an array of antennas (e.g., the antenna elements **312**) can be steered to transmit radio signals or receive radio signals in a specific spatial direction. Beamforming may include adjusting the phases of signals transmitted by the antenna elements **312** in the array **310** so that the transmitted signals may provide constructive interference in the desired spatial direction and destructive interference in other spatial directions.

(50) In some aspects, the high-band beamformer array **320** may be an integrated circuit (IC) including phase shifters and/or amplifiers configured to vary the phases and/or amplitudes of a signal (e.g., a 39 GHz signal) to produce a set of phase-shifted and/or gain-adjusted signals for beamforming. The high-band beamformer array **320** may provide a plurality of beamformer channels. A beamformer channel may include phase-shifters, amplifiers, transmit/receive switches, and/or input/output ports (e.g., similar to the beamformers **622** shown in FIG. **6**). Each beamformer channel may perform beamforming operations independent from each other. Each beamformer channel may generate one of the phase-shifted and/or gain-adjusted signals in the set. For transmission, the plurality of beamformer channels may be coupled to at least a subset of the antenna elements **312** to feed the set of phase-shifted and/or gain-adjusted signals to the subset of the antenna elements **312**. More specifically, each beamformer channel may feed a different one of the phase-shifted and/or gain-adjusted signals to a different antenna element **312** in the subset. That is, each antenna element **312** in the subset may transmit the same signal but with different phases and/or gains. A signal radiated or emitted by the antenna array **310** may have a radiation pattern

with a main beam (e.g., directing to a particular direction) generated based on constructive interference of RF signals emitted by the subset of the antenna elements **312**.

(51) In some aspects, the high-band beamformer array **320** may include a plurality of input/output ports, and each beamformer channel may have an associated port for interfacing (e.g., receiving from and/or transmitting to) with the channel. As mentioned above, each antenna element **312** may have a high-band excitation stripline and a low-band excitation stripline. Accordingly, each antenna element **312** may be coupled to at least one of the beamformer channels (or channel ports) of the high-band beamformer array **320** by a corresponding high-band excitation stripline of the antenna element **312** so that a signal in a high-frequency band (e.g., a 39 GHz band) may be fed to and/or from the antenna element **312** for beamforming as shown by the arrows **302**. For instance, the subset of antenna elements **312** may together transmit a beamformed signal in the low-frequency band (e.g., a 39 GHz band) that is focused or directed to a certain direction.

(52) In a similar way, the low-band beamformer array **322** may be an IC including phase shifters and/or amplifiers configured to vary the phases and/or amplitudes of a signal (e.g., a 28 GHz signal) to generate a set of phase-shifted and/or gain-adjusted signals for beamforming. The low-band beamformer array **322** may provide a plurality of beamformer channels, where each beamform channel may generate one of the phase-shifted and/or gain-adjusted signals in the set. The plurality of beamformer channels may be coupled to at least a subset of the antenna elements **312** to feed the set of phase-shifted and/or gain-adjusted signals to the subset of the antenna elements **312**. More specifically, each beamformer channel may feed a different one of the phase-shifted and/or gain-adjusted signals to a different antenna element **312** in the subset. In some aspects, the low-band beamformer array **322** may include a plurality of input/output ports, and each beamformer channel may have an associated port for interfacing (e.g., receiving from and/or transmitting to) with the channel. Each antenna element **312** may be coupled to at least one of the beamformer channels (or channel ports) of the low-band beamformer array **322** by a corresponding low-band excitation stripline of the antenna element **312** so that a signal in a low-frequency band (e.g., a 28 GHz band) may be fed to and/or from the antenna element **312** for beamforming as shown by the arrows **304**. For instance, the subset of antenna elements **312** may together transmit a beamformed signal in the low-frequency band (e.g., a 28 GHz band) that is focused or directed to a certain direction.

(53) FIG. **4** is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary dual wideband antenna apparatus **400**, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. The antenna apparatus **400** may be used in an RF system for wireless transmission and/or reception. In some instances, the antenna apparatus **400** may be part of the antenna apparatus **600** of FIG. **6**. The antenna apparatus **400** may be substantially similar to the antenna apparatus **400** but may include a single beamformer for both a high-frequency band and a low-frequency band instead of having separate high-band beamformer and low-band beamformer as in the apparatus **300**.

(54) As shown in FIG. **4**, the antenna apparatus **400** may include an antenna array **310** and a beamformer array **420**. The antenna array **310** may include an array of antenna elements **312**, for example, each having a structure with two independent stacked patch antennas (e.g., a high-band patch antenna **120** and a low-band patch antenna **130**) as discussed above with reference to FIGS. **1A-1E** and **2**. In some specific embodiments, the antenna elements **312** may have a structure with dual stripline excitations (e.g., the high-band excitation stripline **252** and the low-band excitation stripline **250**) as discussed above with reference to FIG. **2**.

(55) The beamformer array **420** may be in the form of a single IC. The beamformer array **420** may be substantially similar to the high-band beamformer array **320** and the low-band beamformer array **322**. For instance, the beamformer array **420** may include phase-shifters and/or amplifiers configured to perform beamforming. However, the beamformer array **420** may include a first subset of beamformer channels configured for beamforming signals in a high-frequency band (e.g., a 39 GHz band) and a second subset of beamformer channels that are low-band beamformer

channels configured for beamforming signals in a low-frequency band (e.g., a 28 GHz band). The first subset of beamformer channels is referred to as high-band beamformer channels **422**, and the second subset of beamformer channels is referred to as low-band beamformer channels **424**.

(56) Similar to the high-band beamformer array **320** and low-band beamformer array **322**, each of the high-band beamformer channels **422** may include a phase-shifter and/or an amplifier to vary the phase and/or an amplitude of a high-frequency signal for beamforming in a specific spatial direction and each channel **422** may have an associated input/output port for interfacing (e.g., receiving from and/or transmitting to) with the channel **422**. In a similar way, each of the low-band beamformer channels **424** may include a phase-shifter and/or an amplifier vary the phase and/or an amplitude a low-frequency signal differently for beamforming in a specific spatial direction and each channel **424** may have an associated input/output port for interfacing (e.g., receiving from and/or transmitting to) with the channel **424**.

(57) As further shown in FIG. **4**, the high-band beamformer channels **422** and the low-band beamformer channels **424** may be arranged physically in an interleaving manner. Phrased differently, the high-band beamformer channels **422** may be spaced apart from each other by one of the low-band beamformer channels **424**. As an example, each high-band beamformer channel **422** or low-band beamformer channel **424** may be a complete channel unit independent of each other (e.g., each including phase-shifters, amplifiers, transmit/receive switches, and/or input/output ports), where the beamformer array **420** may include alternating first channel units corresponding to the high-band beamformer channels **422** and second channel units corresponding to the low-band beamformer channel **424**. Each antenna element **312** may be coupled to at least one of the high-band beamformer channels **422** by a respective high-band excitation stripline (e.g., the high-band excitation stripline **252**) of the antenna element **312** and at least one of the low-band beamformer channels **424** by a respective low-band excitation stripline (e.g., the low-band excitation stripline **250**) of the antenna element **312**. The interleaving arrangement of the high-band beamformer channels **422** and the low-band beamformer channels **424** can simplify the interface to the antenna elements **312** as each antenna element **312** may be coupled to one of the high-band beamformer channels **422** and one of the low-band beamformer channels **424**.

(58) FIG. **5** is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary dual wideband antenna apparatus **500**, according to some embodiments of the disclosure. The antenna apparatus **500** may be used in an RF system for wireless transmission and/or reception. In some instances, the antenna apparatus **500** may be part of the antenna apparatus **600** of FIG. **6**. The antenna apparatus **500** may be substantially similar to the antenna apparatus **400** but may include a beamformer with dual band beamformer channels instead of having separate high-band beamformer channels and low-band beamformer channels as in the apparatus **400**.

(59) As shown in FIG. **5**, the antenna apparatus **500** may include an antenna array **310** and a beamformer array **520**. The antenna array **310** may include an array of antenna elements **312**, for example, each having a structure with two independent stacked patch antennas (e.g., a high-band patch antenna **120** and a low-band patch antenna **130**) as discussed above with reference to FIGS. **1A-1E** and **2**. In some specific embodiments, the antenna elements **312** may have a structure with a single stripline excitation (e.g., the excitation stripline **152**) for both a high-frequency band (e.g., a 39 GHz band) and a low-frequency band (e.g., a 28 GHz band) and may include a FSC element (e.g., the FSC element **154**) as discussed above with reference to FIG. **1B**.

(60) In some aspects, the beamformer array **520** may be in the form of a single IC. The beamformer array **520** may be substantially similar to the beamformer arrays **320**, **322**, and/or **420**. However, the beamformer array **520** may include a plurality of dual band beamformer channels **522**. Each of the dual band beamformer channels **522** may include a set of phase-shifter and/or an amplifier for beamforming a high-frequency signal in a specific spatial direction and another set of phase-shifter and/or an amplifier for beamforming a low-frequency signal in a specific spatial direction. Further, each dual band beamformer channel **522** may have an associated input/output port for interfacing

(e.g., receiving from and/or transmitting to) with the channel 522. Accordingly, each antenna element 312 may be coupled to at least one of the dual band beamformer channels 522 by a common excitation stripline (e.g., the excitation stripline 152) and a FSC element 154 of the antenna element 312. More specifically, each dual band beamformer channel 522 may feed a low-frequency signal in the low-frequency band and/or a high-frequency signal in the high-frequency band to the associated antenna element 312. The low-frequency signal may be delivered to a low-band excitation via (e.g., the low-band excitation via 132) of the antenna element, and the FSC element 154 of the antenna element 312 may pass or couple the high-frequency signal to a high-band excitation via (e.g., the high-band excitation via 122) of the antenna element 312.

(61) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram of an exemplary antenna apparatus 600, e.g., a phased array system/apparatus, in which compact, wideband antenna elements are utilized to provide a wide scan range, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 6, the antenna apparatus 600 may include an antenna array 610, a beamformer array 620, a UDC circuit 640, and a controller 670.

(62) In general, the antenna array 610 may include a plurality of antenna elements 612 (only one of which is labeled with a reference numeral in FIG. 6 in order to not clutter the drawing), housed in (e.g., in or over) a substrate 614, where the substrate 614 may be, e.g., a PCB or any other support structure. In various embodiments, the antenna elements 612 may be radiating elements or passive elements. For example, the antenna elements 612 may include dipoles, open-ended waveguides, slotted waveguides, microstrip antennas, and the like. In some embodiments, the antenna elements 612 may include any suitable elements configured to wirelessly transmit and/or receive RF signals. The antenna array 610 may be a phased array antenna and, therefore, will be referred to as such in the following. In some embodiments, the phased array antenna 610 may be a printed phased array antenna. In some embodiments, the antenna array 610 may be similar to the antenna array 310 of FIGS. 3-5.

(63) At least some of the antenna elements 612 may be implemented using two independent stacked patch antennas (e.g., a high-band patch antenna 120 and a low-band patch antenna 130) arranged on a multi-layered structure (e.g., a multi-layer PCB stack-up) with a single stripline excitation or dual stripline excitations as discussed herein, and configured to have provide dual wideband operations. Further details shown in FIG. 6, such as the particular arrangement of the beamformer array 620, of the UDC circuit 640, and the relation between the beamformer array 620 and the UDC circuit 640 may be different in different embodiments, with the description of FIG. 6 providing only some examples of how these components may be used together with the phased array antenna 610 including antenna elements 612 configured, for example, using the antenna structures 100 and/or 200. Furthermore, although some embodiments shown in the present drawings illustrate a certain number of components (e.g., a certain number of antenna elements 612, beamformers, and/or UDC circuits), it is appreciated that these embodiments may be implemented with any number of these components in accordance with the descriptions provided herein. Furthermore, although the disclosure may discuss certain embodiments with reference to certain types of components of an antenna apparatus (e.g., referring to a substrate that houses antenna element as a PCB although in general it may be any suitable support structure), it is understood that the embodiments disclosed herein may be implemented with different types of components.

(64) The beamformer array 620 may include a plurality of beamformers 622 (only one of which is labeled with a reference numeral in FIG. 6 in order to not clutter the drawing). The beamformers 622 may be seen as transceivers (e.g., devices which may transmit and/or receive signals, in this case—RF signals) that feed to antenna elements 612. In some embodiments, a single beamformer 622 may be associated with (i.e., exchange signals with, e.g., feed signals to) one of the antenna elements 612 (e.g., in a one-to-one correspondence). In other embodiments, multiple beamformers 622 may be associated with a single antenna element 612. Yet in other embodiments, a single

beamformer **622** may be associated with a plurality of antenna elements **612**. In some embodiments, when a given antenna element **612** is implemented with the antenna structure **100** or **200** as discussed herein (e.g., two independent stacked patch antennas (e.g., a high-band patch antenna **120** and a low-band patch antenna **130**) arranged on a multi-layered structure (e.g., a multi-layer PCB stack-up)), a dual band beamformer **622** may be configured to support signals for dual band beamforming. In general, one or more beamformers **622** may be connected to each antenna element **612** to support beamforming for signals in a high-frequency band (e.g., with one of a vertical polarization or a horizontal polarization) and in a low-frequency band (e.g., with the other one of the vertical polarization or the horizontal polarization). In some embodiments, the beamformers **622** may correspond to the beamformer channels in the beamformer arrays **320** and **322**, the beamformer channels **422** and **424** in the beamformer array **420**, and/or beamformer channels **522** in the beamformer array **520** discussed above.

(65) In some embodiments, each of the beamformers **622** may include a switch **624** to switch the path from the corresponding antenna element **612** to the receiver or the transmitter path. Although not specifically shown in FIG. **6**, in some embodiments, each of the beamformers **622** may also include another switch to switch the path from a signal processor (also not shown) to the receiver or the transmitter path. As shown in FIG. **6**, in some embodiments, the transmit path (TX path) of each of the beamformers **622** may include a phase shifter **626** and a variable (e.g., programmable) gain amplifier **628**, while the receive path (RX path) may include a phase shifter **630** and a variable (e.g., programmable) gain amplifier **632**. The phase shifter **626** may be configured to adjust the phase of the RF signal to be transmitted (TX signal) by the antenna element **612** and the variable gain amplifier **628** may be configured to adjust the amplitude of the TX signal to be transmitted by the antenna element **612**. Similarly, the phase shifter **630** and the variable gain amplifier **632** may be configured to adjust the RF signal received (RX signal) by the antenna element **612** before providing the RX signal to further circuitry, e.g., to the UDC circuit **640**, to the signal processor (not shown), etc. The beamformers **622** may be considered to be “in the RF path” of the antenna apparatus **600** because the signals traversing the beamformers **622** are RF signals (i.e., TX signals which may traverse the beamformers **622** are RF signals upconverted by the UDC circuit **640** from lower frequency signals, e.g., from intermediate frequency (IF) signals or from baseband signals, while RX signals which may traverse the beamformers **622** are RF signals which have not yet been downconverted by the UDC circuit **640** to lower frequency signals, e.g., to IF signals or to baseband signals).

(66) Although a switch is shown in FIG. **6** to switch from the transmitter path to the receive path (i.e., the switch **624**), in other embodiments of the beamformer **622**, other components can be used, such as a duplexer. Furthermore, although FIG. **6** illustrates an embodiment where the beamformers **622** include the phase shifters **626**, **630** (which may also be referred to as “phase adjusters”) and the variable gain amplifiers **628**, **632**, in other embodiments, any of the beamformers **622** may include other components to adjust the magnitude and/or the phase of the TX and/or RX signals. In some embodiments, one or more of the beamformers **622** may not include the phase shifter **626** and/or the phase shifter **630** because the desired phase adjustment may, alternatively, be performed using a phase shift module in the local oscillator (LO) path. In other embodiments, phase adjustment performed in the LO path may be combined with phase adjustment performed in the RF path using the phase shifters of the beamformers **622**.

(67) Turning to the details of the UDC, in general, the UDC circuit **640** may include an upconverter and/or downconverter circuitry, i.e., in various embodiments, the UDC circuit **640** may include 6) an upconverter circuit but no downconverter circuit, 2) a downconverter circuit but no upconverter circuit, or 3) both an upconverter circuit and a downconverter circuit. As shown in FIG. **6**, in some embodiments, the downconverter circuit of the UDC circuit **640** may include an amplifier **642** and a mixer **644**, while the upconverter circuit of the UDC circuit **640** may include an amplifier **646** and a mixer **648**. In some embodiments, the UDC circuit **640** may further include a phase shift

module **650**.

(68) In various embodiments, the term “UDC circuit” may be used to include frequency conversion circuitry (e.g., a frequency mixer configured to perform upconversion to RF signals for wireless transmission, a frequency mixer configured to perform downconversion of received RF signals, or both), as well as any other components that may be included in a broader meaning of this term, such as filters, analog-to-digital converters (ADCs), digital-to-analog converters (DACs), transformers, and other circuit elements typically used in association with frequency mixers. In all of these variations, the term “UDC circuit” covers implementations where the UDC circuit **640** only includes circuit elements related to the TX path (e.g., only an upconversion mixer but not a downconversion mixer; in such implementations the UDC circuit may be used as/in an RF transmitter for generating RF signals for transmission), implementations where the UDC circuit **640** only includes circuit elements related to the RX path (e.g., only a downconversion mixer but not an upconversion mixer; in such implementations the UDC circuit **640** may be used as/in an RF receiver to downconvert received RF signals, e.g., the UDC circuit **640** may enable an antenna element of the phased array antenna **610** to act, or be used, as a receiver), as well as implementations where the UDC circuit **640** includes, both, circuit elements of the TX path and circuit elements of the RX path (e.g., both the upconversion mixer and the downconversion mixer; in such implementations the UDC circuit **640** may be used as/in an RF transceiver, e.g., the UDC circuit **640** may enable an antenna element of the phased array antenna **610** to act, or be used, as a transceiver).

(69) Although a single UDC circuit **640** is illustrated in FIG. 6, multiple UDC circuits **640** may be included in the antenna apparatus **600** to provide upconverted RF signals to and/or receive RF signals to be downconverted from any one of the beamformers **622**. Each UDC circuit **640** may be associated with a plurality of beamformers **622** of the beamformer array **620**, e.g., using a splitter/combiner. This is schematically illustrated in FIG. 6 with dashed lines and dotted lines within the splitter/combiner connecting various elements of the beamformer array **620** and the UDC circuit **640**. Namely, FIG. 6 illustrates that the dashed lines connect the downconverter circuit of the UDC circuit **640** (namely, the amplifier **642**) to the RX paths of two different beamformers **622**, and that the dotted lines connect the upconverter circuit of the UDC circuit **640** (namely, the amplifier **646**) to the TX paths of two different beamformers **622**. For example, there may be 96 beamformers **622** in the beamformer array **620**, associated with 96 antenna elements **612** of the phased array antenna **610**.

(70) In some embodiments, the mixer **644** in the downconverter path (i.e., RX path) of the UDC circuit **640** may have at least two inputs and one output. One of the inputs of the mixer **644** may include an input from the amplifier **642**, which may, e.g., be a low-noise amplifier (LNA). The second input of the mixer **644** may include an input indicative of the LO signal **660**. In some embodiments, phase shifting may be implemented in the LO path (additionally or alternatively to the phase shifting in the RF path), in which case the LO signal **660** may be provided, first, to a phase shift module **650**, and then a phase-shifted LO signal **660** is provided as the second input to the mixer **644**. In the embodiments where phase shifting in the LO path is not implemented, the phase shift module **650** may be absent and the second input of the mixer **644** may be configured to receive the LO signal **660**. The one output of the mixer **644** is an output to provide the downconverted signal **656**, which may, e.g., be an IF signal **656**. The mixer **644** may be configured to receive an RF RX signal from the RX path of one of the beamformers **622**, after it has been amplified by the amplifier **642**, at its first input and receive either a signal from the phase shift module **650** or the LO signal **660** itself at its second input, and mix these two signals to downconvert the RF RX signal to a lower frequency, producing the downconverted RX signal **656**, e.g., the RX signal at the IF. Thus, the mixer **644** in the downconverter path of the UDC circuit **640** may be referred to as a “downconverting mixer.”

(71) In some embodiments, the mixer **648** in the upconverter path (i.e., TX path) of the UDC

circuit **640** may have [at least] two inputs and one output. The first input of the mixer **648** may be an input for receiving a TX signal **658** of a lower frequency, e.g., the TX signal at IF. The second input of the mixer **648** may include an input indicative of the LO signal **660**. In the embodiments where phase shifting is implemented in the LO path (either additionally or alternatively to the phase shifting in the RF path), the LO signal **660** may be provided, first, to a phase shift module **650**, and then a phase-shifted LO signal **660** is provided as the second input to the mixer **648**. In the embodiments where phase shifting in the LO path is not implemented, the phase shift module **650** may be absent and the second input of the mixer **648** may be configured to receive the LO signal **660**. The one output of the mixer **648** is an output to the amplifier **646**, which may, e.g., be a power amplifier (PA). The mixer **648** may be configured to receive an IF TX signal **658** (i.e., the lower frequency, e.g. IF, signal to be transmitted) at its first input and receive either a signal from the phase shift module **650** or the LO signal **660** itself at its second input, and mix these two signals to upconvert the IF TX signal to the desired RF frequency, producing the upconverted RF TX signal to be provided, after it has been amplified by the amplifier **646**, to the TX path of one of the beamformers **622**. Thus, the mixer **648** in the upconverter path of the UDC circuit **640** may be referred to as a “upconverting mixer.”

(72) In some embodiments, the amplifier **628** may be a PA and/or the amplifier **632** may be an LNA.

(73) As is known in communications and electronic engineering, an IF is a frequency to which a carrier wave is shifted as an intermediate step in transmission or reception. The IF signal may be created by mixing the carrier signal with an LO signal in a process called heterodyning, resulting in a signal at the difference or beat frequency. Conversion to IF may be useful for several reasons. One reason is that, when several stages of filters are used, they can all be set to a fixed frequency, which makes them easier to build and to tune. Another reason is that lower frequency transistors generally have higher gains so fewer stages may be required. Yet another reason is to improve frequency selectivity because it may be easier to make sharply selective filters at lower fixed frequencies. It should also be noted that, while some descriptions provided herein refer to signals **656** and **658** as IF signals, these descriptions are equally applicable to embodiments where signals **656** and **658** are baseband signals. In such embodiments, frequency mixing of the mixers **644** and **648** may be a zero-IF mixing (also referred to as a “zero-IF conversion”) in which the LO signal **660** used to perform the mixing may have a center frequency in the band of RF RX/TX frequencies.

(74) Although not specifically shown in FIG. 6, in further embodiments, the UDC circuit **640** may further include a balancer, e.g., in each of the TX and RX paths, configured to mitigate imbalances in the in-phase and quadrature (IQ) signals due to mismatching. Furthermore, although also not specifically shown in FIG. 6, in other embodiments, the antenna apparatus **600** may include further instances of a combination of the phased array antenna **610**, the beamformer array **620**, and the UDC circuit **640** as described herein.

(75) The controller **670** may include any suitable device, configured to control operation of various parts of the antenna apparatus **600**. For example, in some embodiments, the controller **670** may control the amount and the timing of phase shifting implemented in the antenna apparatus **600**. In another example, in some embodiments, the controller **670** may control various signals, as well as the timing of those signals, provided to the antenna elements **612** implemented using the antenna structures **100** and/or **200** in the antenna array **610** to provide dual band operations and/or a wide scan range.

(76) The antenna apparatus **600** can steer an electromagnetic radiation pattern of the phased array antenna **610** in a particular direction, thereby enabling the phased array antenna **610** to generate a main beam in that direction and side lobes in other directions. The main beam of the radiation pattern is generated based on constructive interference of the transmitted RF signals based on the transmitted signals' phases. The side lobe levels may be determined by the amplitudes of the RF

signals transmitted by the antenna elements. The antenna apparatus **600** can generate desired antenna patterns by providing phase shifter settings for the antenna elements **612**, e.g., using the phase shifters of the beamformers **622** and/or the phase shift module **650**.

EXAMPLES

- (77) Example 1 includes a dual band antenna structure, including a first patch antenna disposed on a first layer of the structure; a second patch antenna disposed on a second layer of the structure, where the second layer is vertically below the first layer and spaced apart by a dielectric substrate, and where the second patch antenna has a larger size than the first patch antenna and at least partially overlaps with the first patch antenna; a first excitation conductor electrically coupled to the first patch antenna; and a second excitation conductor electrically coupled to the second patch antenna, where the second excitation conductor is separate from the first excitation conductor.
- Example 2 includes the dual band antenna structure of Example 1, where the first patch antenna has a first resonant frequency within a first frequency band, and where the second patch antenna has a second resonant frequency within a second frequency band separate from the first frequency band.
- (78) Example 3 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-2, where a ratio between the first resonant frequency of the first patch antenna and the second resonant frequency of the second patch antenna is greater than 1 and less than 2.
- (79) Example 4 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-3, where the first patch antenna is associated with a first polarization, and where the second patch antenna is associated with a second polarization different from the first polarization.
- (80) Example 5 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-4, further includes a third excitation conductor disposed on a third layer of the structure, where the third layer is vertically below the second layer, where the first excitation conductor has a first end coupled to the first patch antenna and a second end coupled to the third excitation conductor.
- (81) Example 6 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-5, where the first excitation conductor extends vertically from the third layer to the first layer through the second patch antenna.
- (82) Example 7 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-6, where the first excitation conductor extends vertically from the third layer to the first layer through a short circuit line of the second patch antenna.
- (83) Example 8 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-7, further includes a fourth excitation conductor disposed on the third layer, where the fourth excitation conductor is separate from the third excitation conductor, where the second excitation conductor has a first end coupled to the second patch antenna and a second end coupled to the fourth excitation conductor.
- (84) Example 9 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-7, further includes a frequency selective coupling element disposed on the third layer of the structure and coupled between the first excitation conductor and the third excitation conductor.
- (85) Example 10 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-9, further includes a first ground layer vertically below the second layer; and a second ground layer vertically below the first ground layer, where the third layer in which the third excitation conductor is disposed is between the first ground layer and the second ground layer.
- (86) Example 11 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 1-10, where the first layer, the second layer, the third layer, the first ground layer, and the second ground layer are spaced apart from each other by dielectric material.
- (87) Example 12 includes a dual band antenna structure, including a high-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a first signal in a first frequency band; a low-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a second signal in a second frequency band lower than the first frequency band, where the low-band patch antenna is stacked vertically below the high-band patch antenna and spaced apart from the high-band patch antenna by a dielectric substrate; a high-band excitation via electrically coupled to the high-band patch antenna; and a low-band excitation via electrically

coupled to the low-band patch antenna, where the high-band excitation via is separate from the low-band excitation via.

(88) Example 13 includes the dual band antenna structure of Example 12, where the high-band patch antenna further communicates the first signal in one of a horizontal polarization or a vertical polarization, and where the low-band patch antenna further communicates the second signal in the other one of the horizontal polarization or the vertical polarization.

(89) Example 14 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 12-13, further includes a first excitation stripline coupled to at least one of the high-band excitation via or the low-band excitation via.

(90) Example 15 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 12-14, where the first excitation stripline is coupled to the high-band excitation via; and the dual band antenna structure further includes a second excitation stripline coupled to the low-band excitation via, where the second excitation stripline is separate from the first excitation stripline.

(91) Example 16 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 12-14, where the first excitation stripline is coupled to the high-band excitation via and the low-band excitation via; and the dual band antenna structure further includes a frequency selective coupling element having a first terminal connected to the high-band excitation via and a second terminal connected to the low-band excitation via.

(92) Example 17 includes the dual band antenna structure of any of Examples 12-16, where at least one of the high-band patch antenna has a conductive plane with a U-shaped opening; or the low-band patch antenna has a conductive plane with a U-shaped opening.

(93) Example 18 includes a dual band antenna array apparatus, including a plurality of dual band antenna elements, where a first dual band antenna element of the plurality of dual band antenna elements includes a high-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a first signal in a first frequency band; a low-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a second signal in a second frequency band lower than the first frequency band, where the low-band patch antenna is stacked below the high-band patch antenna and spaced apart from the high-band patch antenna by a dielectric substrate; a high-band excitation conductor electrically coupled to the high-band patch antenna; and a low-band excitation conductor electrically coupled to the low-band patch antenna, where the low-band excitation conductor is separate from the high-band excitation conductor; and beamformer circuitry coupled to one or more of the plurality of dual band antenna elements, where the beamformer circuitry includes a plurality of beamformer channels.

(94) Example 19 includes the dual band antenna array apparatus of Example 18, where a first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels are associated with the first frequency band, and where a second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels are associated with the second frequency band.

(95) Example 20 includes the dual band antenna array apparatus of any of Examples 18-19, where the beamformer circuitry includes a first beamformer integrated circuit including the first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the first frequency band; and a second beamformer integrated circuit including the second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the second frequency band.

(96) Example 21 includes the dual band antenna array apparatus of any of Examples 18-19, further includes a beamformer integrated circuit including the plurality of beamformer channels, where the first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the first frequency band are spaced apart from each other by the second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the second frequency band in the beamformer integrated circuit.

(97) Example 22 includes the dual band antenna array apparatus of any of Examples 18-19, where the first dual band antenna element is coupled to a first beamformer channel in the first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels by the high-band excitation conductor; and a second beamformer channel in the second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels by the low-band

excitation conductor.

(98) Example 23 includes the dual band antenna array apparatus of Example 18, where the beamformer channels in the beamformer circuitry are dual band beamformer channels; the first dual band antenna element further includes a frequency selective coupling element; and a common excitation conductor coupled to one of the high-band excitation conductor or the low-band excitation conductor directly and coupled to the other one of the high-band excitation conductor or the low-band excitation conductor via the common excitation conductor; and the first dual band antenna element is further coupled to one of the dual band beamformer channels by the common excitation conductor.

Variations and Implementations

(99) While embodiments of the present disclosure were described above with references to exemplary implementations as shown in FIGS. 1A-1E and 2-6, a person skilled in the art will realize that the various teachings described above are applicable to a large variety of other implementations.

(100) In certain contexts, the features discussed herein can be applicable to automotive systems, safety-critical industrial applications, medical systems, scientific instrumentation, wireless and wired communications, radio, radar, industrial process control, audio and video equipment, current sensing, instrumentation (which can be highly precise), and other digital-processing-based systems.

(101) In the discussions of the embodiments above, components of a system, such as filters, frequency selective coupling elements, phase-shifters, vias, and/or other components can readily be replaced, substituted, or otherwise modified in order to accommodate particular circuitry needs. Moreover, it should be noted that the use of complementary electronic devices, hardware, software, etc., offer an equally viable option for implementing the teachings of the present disclosure related to dual wideband antennas, in various communication systems.

(102) In one example embodiment, any number of electrical circuits of the present figures may be implemented on a board of an associated electronic device. The board can be a general circuit board that can hold various components of the internal electronic system of the electronic device and, further, provide connectors for other peripherals. More specifically, the board can provide the electrical connections by which the other components of the system can communicate electrically. Any suitable processors (inclusive of DSPs, microprocessors, supporting chipsets, etc.), computer-readable non-transitory memory elements, etc. can be suitably coupled to the board based on particular configuration needs, processing demands, computer designs, etc. Other components such as external storage, additional sensors, controllers for audio/video display, and peripheral devices may be attached to the board as plug-in cards, via cables, or integrated into the board itself. In various embodiments, the functionalities described herein may be implemented in emulation form as software or firmware running within one or more configurable (e.g., programmable) elements arranged in a structure that supports these functions. The software or firmware providing the emulation may be provided on non-transitory computer-readable storage medium comprising instructions to allow a processor to carry out those functionalities.

(103) In another example embodiment, the electrical circuits of the present figures may be implemented as stand-alone modules (e.g., a device with associated components and circuitry configured to perform a specific application or function) or implemented as plug-in modules into application specific hardware of electronic devices. Note that particular embodiments of the present disclosure may be readily included in a system on chip (SOC) package, either in part, or in whole. An SOC represents an IC that integrates components of a computer or other electronic system into a single chip. It may contain digital, analog, mixed-signal, and often RF functions: all of which may be provided on a single chip substrate. Other embodiments may include a multi-chip-module (MCM), with a plurality of separate ICs located within a single electronic package and configured to interact closely with each other through the electronic package.

(104) It is also imperative to note that all of the specifications, dimensions, and relationships

outlined herein (e.g., the number of components of the antenna structures and/or antenna apparatuses shown in FIGS. 1A-1E and 2-6) have only been offered for purposes of example and teaching only. Such information may be varied considerably without departing from the spirit of the present disclosure, or the scope of the appended claims. It should be appreciated that the system can be consolidated in any suitable manner. Along similar design alternatives, any of the illustrated circuits, components, modules, and elements of the present figures may be combined in various possible configurations, all of which are clearly within the broad scope of this specification. In the foregoing description, example embodiments have been described with reference to particular processor and/or component arrangements. Various modifications and changes may be made to such embodiments without departing from the scope of the appended claims. The description and drawings are, accordingly, to be regarded in an illustrative rather than in a restrictive sense.

(105) Note that with the numerous examples provided herein, interaction may be described in terms of two, three, four, or more electrical components. However, this has been done for purposes of clarity and example only. It should be appreciated that the system can be consolidated in any suitable manner. Along similar design alternatives, any of the illustrated components, modules, and elements of the FIGURES may be combined in various possible configurations, all of which are clearly within the broad scope of this Specification. In certain cases, it may be easier to describe one or more of the functionalities of a given set of flows by only referencing a limited number of electrical elements. It should be appreciated that the electrical circuits of the FIGURES and its teachings are readily scalable and can accommodate a large number of components, as well as more complicated/sophisticated arrangements and configurations. Accordingly, the examples provided should not limit the scope or inhibit the broad teachings of the electrical circuits as potentially applied to a myriad of other architectures.

(106) Note that in this Specification, references to various features (e.g., elements, structures, modules, components, steps, operations, characteristics, etc.) included in “one embodiment”, “example embodiment”, “an embodiment”, “another embodiment”, “some embodiments”, “various embodiments”, “other embodiments”, “alternative embodiment”, and the like are intended to mean that any such features are included in one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, but may or may not necessarily be combined in the same embodiments. Also, as used herein, including in the claims, “or” as used in a list of items (for example, a list of items prefaced by a phrase such as “at least one of” or “one or more of”) indicates an inclusive list such that, for example, a list of [at least one of A, B, or C] means A or B or C or AB or AC or BC or ABC (i.e., A and B and C).

(107) Various aspects of the illustrative embodiments are described using terms commonly employed by those skilled in the art to convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. For example, the term “connected” means a direct electrical connection between the things that are connected, without any intermediary devices/components, while the term “coupled” means either a direct electrical connection between the things that are connected, or an indirect connection through one or more passive or active intermediary devices/components. In another example, the term “circuit” means one or more passive and/or active components that are arranged to cooperate with one another to provide a desired function. Also, as used herein, the terms “substantially,” “approximately,” “about,” etc., may be used to generally refer to being within $\pm 20\%$ of a target value, e.g., within $\pm 10\%$ of a target value, based on the context of a particular value as described herein or as known in the art.

(108) Numerous other changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and modifications may be ascertained to one skilled in the art and it is intended that the present disclosure encompass all such changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and modifications as falling within the scope of the examples and appended claims. Note that all optional features of the apparatus described above may also be implemented with respect to the method or process described herein and specifics in the examples may be used anywhere in one or more embodiments.

Claims

1. A dual band antenna structure, comprising: a first patch antenna disposed on a first layer of the dual band antenna structure; a second patch antenna disposed on a second layer of the dual band antenna structure, wherein the second layer is vertically below the first layer and spaced apart by a dielectric substrate, and wherein the second patch antenna has a larger size than the first patch antenna and at least partially overlaps with the first patch antenna, with the second patch antenna having a conductive plane defining an opening at a side of the conductive plane; a first excitation conductor electrically coupled to the first patch antenna through the opening; and a second excitation conductor electrically coupled to the second patch antenna, wherein the second excitation conductor is separate from the first excitation conductor.
2. The dual band antenna structure of claim 1, wherein the first patch antenna has a first resonant frequency within a first frequency band, and wherein the second patch antenna has a second resonant frequency within a second frequency band separate from the first frequency band.
3. The dual band antenna structure of claim 2, wherein a ratio between the first resonant frequency of the first patch antenna and the second resonant frequency of the second patch antenna is greater than 1 and less than 2.
4. The dual band antenna structure of claim 1, wherein the first patch antenna is associated with a first polarization, and wherein the second patch antenna is associated with a second polarization different from the first polarization.
5. The dual band antenna structure of claim 1, further comprising: a third excitation conductor disposed on a third layer of the dual band antenna structure, wherein the third layer is vertically below the second layer, wherein the first excitation conductor has a first end coupled to the first patch antenna and a second end coupled to the third excitation conductor.
6. The dual band antenna structure of claim 5, wherein the first excitation conductor extends vertically from the third layer to the first layer through the second patch antenna.
7. The dual band antenna structure of claim 5, wherein the first excitation conductor extends vertically from the third layer to the first layer through a short circuit line of the second patch antenna.
8. The dual band antenna structure of claim 5, further comprising: a fourth excitation conductor disposed on the third layer, wherein the fourth excitation conductor is separate from the third excitation conductor, wherein the second excitation conductor has a first end coupled to the second patch antenna and a second end coupled to the fourth excitation conductor.
9. The dual band antenna structure of claim 5, further comprising: a frequency selective coupling element disposed on the third layer of the dual band antenna structure and coupled between the first excitation conductor and the third excitation conductor.
10. A dual band antenna structure, comprising: a high-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a first signal in a first frequency band; a low-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a second signal in a second frequency band lower than the first frequency band, wherein the low-band patch antenna is stacked vertically below the high-band patch antenna and spaced apart from the high-band patch antenna by a dielectric substrate, with the low-band patch antenna having a conductive plane defining an opening at a side of the conductive plane; a high-band excitation via electrically coupled to the high-band patch antenna through the opening; and a low-band excitation via electrically coupled to the low-band patch antenna, wherein the high-band excitation via is separate from the low-band excitation via.
11. The dual band antenna structure of claim 10, wherein the high-band patch antenna further communicates the first signal in one of a horizontal polarization or a vertical polarization, and wherein the low-band patch antenna further communicates the second signal in the other one of the horizontal polarization or the vertical polarization.

12. The dual band antenna structure of claim 10, further comprising: a first excitation stripline coupled to at least one of the high-band excitation via or the low-band excitation via.
 13. The dual band antenna structure of claim 12, wherein: the first excitation stripline is coupled to the high-band excitation via; and the dual band antenna structure further comprises: a second excitation stripline coupled to the low-band excitation via, wherein the second excitation stripline is separate from the first excitation stripline.
 14. The dual band antenna structure of claim 12, wherein: the first excitation stripline is coupled to the high-band excitation via and the low-band excitation via; and the dual band antenna structure further comprises: a frequency selective coupling element having a first terminal connected to the high-band excitation via and a second terminal connected to the low-band excitation via.
 15. The dual band antenna structure of claim 10, wherein at least one of: the high-band patch antenna has a conductive plane with a U-shaped opening; or the conductive plane of the low-band patch antenna defines a U-shaped opening.
 16. A dual band antenna array apparatus, comprising: a plurality of dual band antenna elements, wherein a first dual band antenna element of the plurality of dual band antenna elements comprises: a high-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a first signal in a first frequency band; a low-band patch antenna to wirelessly communicate a second signal in a second frequency band lower than the first frequency band, wherein the low-band patch antenna is stacked below the high-band patch antenna and spaced apart from the high-band patch antenna by a dielectric substrate, with the low-band patch antenna having a conductive plane defining an opening at a side of the conductive plane; a high-band excitation conductor electrically coupled to the high-band patch antenna through the opening; and a low-band excitation conductor electrically coupled to the low-band patch antenna, wherein the low-band excitation conductor is separate from the high-band excitation conductor; and beamformer circuitry coupled to one or more of the plurality of dual band antenna elements, wherein the beamformer circuitry comprises a plurality of beamformer channels.
 17. The dual band antenna array apparatus of claim 16, wherein the beamformer circuitry comprises: a first beamformer integrated circuit comprising a first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the first frequency band; and a second beamformer integrated circuit comprising a second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the second frequency band.
 18. The dual band antenna array apparatus of claim 16, further comprising: a beamformer integrated circuit comprising the plurality of beamformer channels, wherein a first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the first frequency band are spaced apart from each other by a second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels associated with the second frequency band in the beamformer integrated circuit.
 19. The dual band antenna array apparatus of claim 16, wherein: a first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels are associated with the first frequency band; a second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels are associated with the second frequency band; and the first dual band antenna element is coupled to: a first beamformer channel in the first subset of the plurality of beamformer channels by the high-band excitation conductor; and a second beamformer channel in the second subset of the plurality of beamformer channels by the low-band excitation conductor.
 20. The dual band antenna array apparatus of claim 16, wherein: the beamformer channels in the beamformer circuitry are dual band beamformer channels; the first dual band antenna element further comprises: a frequency selective coupling element; and a common excitation conductor coupled to one of the high-band excitation conductor or the low-band excitation conductor directly and coupled to the other one of the high-band excitation conductor or the low-band excitation conductor via the common excitation conductor; and the first dual band antenna element is further coupled to one of the dual band beamformer channels by the common excitation conductor.
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